



PEDESTRIANS WALK through Toronto’s Chinatown last week. Many cite rising costs and the housing crisis as factors in Canada’s recent skepticism of multiculturalism; others point to the influence of President-elect Donald Trump’s anti-immigrant policies and rhetoric.

Photographs by LAURA PROCTOR For The Times

Anti-immigrant policy, sentiment rising in once-welcoming Canada

Familiar backlash to migration upends lives in a nation often considered ‘the nice guys’



ENRIQUE GARCÍA and his family left Mexico City for Toronto so that his wife could pursue an MBA, which they considered an investment in citizenship.

BY KATE LINTHICUM

TORONTO — Canada long sold itself as a beacon for immigrants, who were widely viewed as key to economic growth in a vast nation with a small and rapidly aging workforce.

“Study, work and stay” was the slogan of a government campaign to lure international students, part of a broader push that included recruiting temporary workers and resettling refugees. After President Trump banned travel to the U.S. from several Muslim-majority countries in 2017, Prime Minister Justin Trudeau announced that Canada’s doors were open.

“To those fleeing persecution, terror and war, Canadians will welcome you,

regardless of your faith,” he wrote on the platform now known as X. “Diversity is our strength.”

But in recent months, Canada has changed course.

For the first time in a quarter-century, a majority of Canadians say there is too much immigration. Hate crimes are on the rise, along with rhetoric blaming newcomers for the country’s economic woes.

Under fire for admitting record numbers of migrants, Trudeau’s government recently slashed the annual total allowed into the country. It also announced a plan to beef up security along the U.S. border.

“The reality is that not everyone is welcome here,” Canada’s immigration minister said at a conference call [See Canada, A4]

Why the Newsom mandate on EVs is in trouble

Sales have stalled, and Trump policies could further hinder goal for zero-emission sales.

BY RUSS MITCHELL

California’s electric vehicle ambitions are facing a reality check.

Sales growth has stalled as potential buyers balk at high sticker prices and unreliable public charging. The EV market will take an additional hit if President-elect Donald Trump follows through on vows to scuttle federal EV tax credit subsidies for buyers and slap tariffs on automobiles made in Mexico, driving prices higher.

The headwinds are fueling fresh doubts about Gov. Gavin Newsom’s mandate that all new cars sold in California by 2035 be zero-emission vehicles. The first big test for the governor’s edict comes next year, when 35% of new vehicles sold must be zero-emission, up from 26.4% now. To hit that mark, EV sales would have to skyrocket 33%.

“I have not seen a forecast by anyone that that number is achievable,” Toyota North America Chief Operating Officer Jack Hollis said on a conference call [See EVs, A8]

High court to hear emissions lawsuit

Justices will consider whether oil industry can challenge California’s EV sales mandate. **NATION, A5**

Criminal justice reformers undeterred

Despite election losses, some reiterate that progressive ideas are essential to safety.

BY JAMES QUEALLY AND ANABEL SOSA

Criminal justice reform advocates spent the summer warning that efforts to oust California’s progressive district attorneys and undo sentencing reforms would undermine a decade of work aimed at reducing mass incarceration, prioritizing rehabilitation and holding police accountable for excessive force.

Come November, voters didn’t listen.

In Los Angeles County, Nathan Hochman, a former federal prosecutor and one-time Republican, unseated George Gascón as district attorney. Progressive firebrand Pamela Price was recalled in Alameda County. And Proposition 36, which will lengthen jail and prison sentences for some drug and theft charges, passed by double-digit margins in all [See Reform, A6]

Will Harris enter governor’s race in 2026?

BY JULIA WICK

As California politicians look ahead to 2025, the biggest question looming is whether Vice President Kamala Harris — a native daughter, battered just weeks ago by presidential election defeat — will enter the 2026 California governor’s race.

Harris has yet to give any public indication on her thoughts, and those close to her suggest the governorship is not immediately top of mind. But if Harris does ultimately run — and that’s a massive *if* — her entrée would seismically reshape the already crowded race for California’s highest office.

Recent polling suggests Harris would have a major advantage, with 46% of likely voters saying they were somewhat or very likely to [See Harris, A6]



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

VICE PRESIDENT Kamala Harris at the Democratic National Convention in Chicago in August. If she were to run for California governor in 2026, it could seismically reshape the race and cause ripple effects on down-ballot contests.

Hope and fear after Assad fall

Thousands hold the first Friday prayers under Syria’s new regime, voicing a range of views. **WORLD, A3**

Fight over fate of county offices

Plan to move staff to Gas Co. Tower and raze Hahn building is criticized. **BUSINESS, A7**

Gang settlement funds go unspent

L.A. has paid only half the amount meant for those hurt by injunctions. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 66/47. **B8**

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